THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION

PARIS BRANCH

NEWSLETTER

DECEMBER 2010

Chairman's Report

Depending on the vagaries of La Poste you are likely to receive this Newsletter after our AGM on Thursday 9th December. For those of you who cannot attend this meeting two items are worth recording here.

Firstly David Blanchard has expressed his wish to stand down from the post of Treasurer after a remarkable 20 year tenure in that office. We owe him a great debt of gratitude for managing our funds with extreme professionalism. He will be remembered not least for monitoring our smooth move from rue Boudreau to rue des Acacias last year, and making not only a capital gain on the disposal, but also investing at a lower price, so that we came out with a cash surplus, which we have in turn invested. As I will have announced at the AGM we do not yet have a candidate to succeed David, and so he has very kindly agreed to continue as acting Treasurer, including the task of coaching his successor whom we shall need to coopt. I am sure that you wish us to mark David's retirement with a suitable event, and in the jargon of the Mess we propose to dine him out. We shall release details of this event shortly.

The second item which will have been discussed at the AGM is the motion which RBL London has required every branch in France to debate at their AGM, namely the formation of a District, akin to an RBL county organization in the UK. This structure would have its own volunteer officers and committee, and would have certain federal responsibilities, principally in the financial and welfare domains, replacing certain of the functions currently carried out by paid executives in RBL London. At our AGM we shall be discussing the perceived advantages and disadvantages of such a structure from the point of view of a French branch like ours. We shall be required to vote in favour or against the motion, and if a majority of French branches vote in favour a district would be formed in 2011.

At our last Committee meeting we agreed to carry an advertisement in our Newsletter for first time, at least in recent memory. It concerns a private health insurance scheme proposed by Charles Wilson, who will be known to many of us in the business community past and present. This form of complementary health care insurance will be of interest to some of our members, we believe. Full details are to be found on Page3 below.

Interestingly advertising as a potential source of donations to the Legion has apparently not been considered in the past. We believe that we should encourage this form of support and if any member is able to introduce us to potential advertisers we should gladly examine such opportunities. Please write/e-mail me with the necessary introductions.

We turn our minds now to the Branch events at Christmas. We warmly thank Tony Bennett will be catering for us at both the Lunch on 15th December, and the Dinner on 17th December. Our Social Secretary tells me there is a waiting list, so if you want to come and have not yet booked do not hesitate to call her on: 01.30.54.33.06 or 06.86.92.92.33.

It now only remains for me to wish you and yours a Merry Christmas and a Happy, Peaceful New Year.

"We will remember them"

SECRETARIES SCREED

Dear Members,

Well yet another year is coming to a close and with it the hustle bustle of preparations for the Festive Season.

At the RBL we are busy getting the final touches for the AGM together. You will have received your bumper package of AGM papers by now. We hope that, weather permitting, we will see as many of you at the meeting as possible.

After the AGM we have the annual Christmas Lunch on 15th December and two days later the Christmas Dinner on 17th December. If you have booked for either of these events and find you cannot attend, would you be so kind as to let Joan Hicks know no later than **2 (two)** days before the date. Our resident cook, Tony Bennett, has to buy the food and we do not want him or us to be out of pocket. If you do not inform Joan of your intentions not to attend we are afraid we cannot reimburse your cheque or money.

Just before the Christmas Dinner, we will hold the Tombola Draw, if you have any gifts you would like to donate to the draw please bring them either to the AGM, Christmas lunch or on the day of the draw. Please note the code to the main gate at Acacia will be changing as from 13th December, it will become 2064#.

Mark Yates would like to remind all members who have not paid their subscription that we would be happy to receive your cheque before the end of the year. We have to send all unpaid cards back to London by the end of January otherwise, we the branch , have to pay for them . This is a cost that we cannot afford.

We would just like to wish you all a Merry Christmas and Happy and healthy New Year.

Janet Warby	Joan Hicks	Mark Yates
Hon Secretary	Social Secretary	Membership Secretary

NOW may be the time.

Now **IS** the time of year when many people look at their complementary health cover, and are invited to renew for 2011 – you are not locked in.

Exclusive Healthcare proposes a range of seven policies to suit most budgets.

We have identified the fact that, when comparing like with like, our prices are **SUBSTANTIALLY LOWER** than the leading French insurers (Axa, Allianz, Credit Agricole/Pacifica…), particularly for the more senior citizens.

Our top-up plans have the following features:

- No medical questions
- No age limit for joining
- Policy documentation and communications in English
- Automatic claims settlement (*tiers payant*)

WE HAVE NEGOTIATED A SPECIFIC REDUCTION FOR MEMBERS OF THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION.

Why not find out more?

- By looking at our website: www.exclusivehealthcare.com
- By dropping us a line, indicating your date(s) of birth
- Or simply phoning our English ladies in St Raphaël on 0494403145 – there is no hash/diaz key to press.

We will respond with courtesy and clarity on comparative conditions and/or cancellation procedures.